

5.2 Population Temporarily Living Abroad

According to the Census of Population and Housing 2024, this analysis in chapter five is presented based on information regarding individuals living abroad temporarily for more than six months. In this context, "individuals temporarily living abroad" refers to persons who belonging to the household, but who have gone abroad for more than 6 months or who have gone abroad with the intention of staying abroad for more than 6 months. (except for permanent residence).

During the census, if there were individuals from a household who were temporarily living abroad, information regarding them was collected through a suitable respondent of that respective household. However, in instances where all members of a household were temporarily living abroad, it was not possible to collect information on those individuals; therefore, such data is not included in this analysis.

According to the Census of Population and Housing 2024, the total number of persons belonging to the household, but who have gone abroad for more than 6 months or who have gone abroad with the intention of staying abroad for more than 6 months. (except for permanent residence) was reported as 672,249.

Information regarding the population temporarily living abroad is presented in Table 5.2.1.

Table 5.2.1 : Population Temporarily Living Abroad by District and Sex, 2024

District	Total		Male		Female	
	No.	%	No.	%	No.	%
Total	672,249	100.0	412,735	100.0	259,514	100.0
Colombo	71,439	10.6	43,531	10.5	27,908	10.8
Gampaha	86,077	12.8	54,734	13.3	31,343	12.1
Kalutara	41,352	6.2	25,238	6.1	16,114	6.2
Kandy	57,230	8.5	35,518	8.6	21,712	8.4
Matale	20,064	3.0	10,682	2.6	9,382	3.6
Nuwara-Eliya	16,913	2.5	6,158	1.5	10,755	4.2
Galle	40,344	6.0	25,283	6.1	15,061	5.8
Matara	21,320	3.2	14,822	3.6	6,498	2.5
Hambantota	14,231	2.1	9,432	2.3	4,799	1.8
Jaffna	9,425	1.4	8,091	2.0	1,334	0.5
Mannar	1,640	0.2	1,228	0.3	412	0.2
Vavuniya	3,621	0.6	2,413	0.6	1,208	0.5
Mullaitivu	1,383	0.2	961	0.2	422	0.2
Kilinochchi	1,625	0.2	1,309	0.3	316	0.1
Batticaloa	28,259	4.2	23,723	5.7	4,536	1.7
Ampara	31,337	4.7	26,917	6.5	4,420	1.7
Trincomalee	11,622	1.7	7,193	1.7	4,429	1.7
Kurunegala	64,116	9.5	34,699	8.4	29,417	11.3
Puttalam	47,223	7.0	27,185	6.6	20,038	7.7
Anuradhapura	25,622	3.8	12,343	3.0	13,279	5.1
Polonnaruwa	13,216	2.0	6,433	1.6	6,783	2.6
Badulla	13,232	2.0	5,749	1.4	7,483	2.9
Moneragala	4,828	0.7	2,765	0.7	2,063	0.8
Ratnapura	18,696	2.8	10,145	2.5	8,551	3.3
Kegalle	27,434	4.1	16,183	3.9	11,251	4.3